

Exam format: MCQ plus written scenarios, not application coding

Claude Certified Developer, Foundation (CCDV-F) · UST masterclass

EN Session 2 of 12 · English notes

Session 2 (5 August 2026) opened with the question the room had after session 1: *will we have to code an application in the exam?* Vijay’s answer was unambiguous. You will not implement the app under the exam clock. You will answer **multiple-choice items** and **descriptive scenarios**—what you would do, which API or product you would pick, how you would enable an agent in an enterprise with guardrails.

What “not coding the app” still requires

Anand asked whether application development would appear. Vijay: you will not “do anything” in the sense of a coding IDE. You *will* describe implementation paths. Lalit summarised it as prompting and decisions that change an agentic workflow. That is the right mental model: the exam tests whether you can **select and justify**, including responsible AI, security, and governance in an org.

- Six use cases (Vijay: know them thoroughly; more detail promised the following day).
- Use definitions from Anthropic documentation, then apply them to the scenario—not slang from another vendor’s course.
- Written answers are “your thought”: approaches, not source files.

Shape of the sitting (as taught that week)

Full numbers for the four tracks landed on 6 August; they belong in your exam-format picture now so you do not study as if this were a three-hour hackathon.

Aspect	Classroom teaching (5–6 August 2026)	How to practise
Question style	MCQ + written / scenario items	After every demo, write a 6–8 line “I would…” paragraph
Developer Foundation volume / time	60 questions, 120 minutes	Two-minute average; flag long stems
Scoring (programme guide)	1000-point scale, pass ~750	Weak scenario writing fails you even if MCQ is lucky
Proctoring / ID	Pearson (and similar) name must match ID	Fix Skilljar legal name via UST account holder <i>before</i> you book
Scheduling	You pick the slot; org may have a preferred vendor	Do not wait for a cohort “exam date”—there isn’t one
Sample item flavour (6 August)	e.g. 10,000 overnight docs, cost-first, not urgent → Messages Batches vs naive parallel Messages	Learn product names: Batches, MCP, Claude Code, Cowork

Topics the scenarios will lean on

Vijay listed enterprise enablement of agents, responsible AI, guardrails, and “how you would do this in an org.” Prompt quality items look like: which prompt is cleaner, what is missing (role, constraints, output schema). SDK/API items are not “is this Java method spelled correctly?” so much as “which approach fits the constraints.” Prompt engineering is a large slice of every Anthropic cert in his later weighting (~18–20%).

Capstone versus the credential

The masterclass may include a team capstone. Vijay was not yet sure how UST would assess it (screen-share was already restricted). That homework is *not* the Pearson exam. Conversely, Percipio course-completion certificates (HR clarified on 6 August) are also not the credential. Keep the three piles separate: UST LMS, Anthropic Academy learning, Pearson/Anthropic exam.

How to read an MCQ stem

The sample he put on screen trained a method: underline the constraints (cost, latency, overnight, PII, “results tomorrow”). Eliminate answers that optimise the wrong axis (synchronous fan-out when Batches exist). If two answers are technically possible, pick the one that matches Anthropic’s named product. Classroom UI (effort sliders, Cowork on or off) must not override the docs if they disagree.

LIVE CLASS VERSUS EXAM BOOKLET

Model names, Batches behaviour, and partner-tier maths change. Prefer docs.claude.com and the current Academy exam page over a screenshot from 5 August.

Study rhythm Vijay implied

1. Learn the official term on Skilljar / docs (so you recognise it in a stem).
2. Rehearse the six use cases as stories: actors, data location, product, tools, risks.
3. Write the responsible-AI sentence every time: what you will not send, who approves connectors, what the model does not retain.

Official documentation

- **Anthropic Academy (Skilljar)**

<https://anthropic.skilljar.com>

Exam registration and the courses whose vocabulary matches the items.

- **Messages API**

<https://docs.claude.com/en/api/messages>

The API named in sample “how would you process this workload?” items.

- **Prompt engineering overview**

<https://docs.claude.com/en/docs/build-with-claude/prompt-engineering/overview>

High weight across certifications.

- **Strengthen guardrails**

<https://docs.claude.com/en/docs/test-and-evaluate/strengthen-guardrails>

Enterprise / responsible-AI scenarios.

- **Claude Docs home**

<https://docs.claude.com/en/home>

Canonical names for products the stems will use.

Study notes distilled from the UST CCD Foundation masterclass. Prefer Anthropic's current docs over session anecdotes. Not official exam material.